AAROHI SRIVASTAVA

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Research Interests: Natural Language Processing, Robustness and Generalization in AI, Responsible and Adaptive AI, Language Models, Language Variation, Speech and Language Technologies.

EDUCATION

University of Notre Dame, Notre Dame, IN — Aug 2021 to May 2027 (Expected)
Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science and Engineering.
M.S. in Computer Science and Engineering (May 2025).

Yale University, New Haven, CT — Aug 2017 to May 2021
B.S. in Computer Science.

HONORS AND AWARDS

[Aug 2026] **Research Ethics Fellowship**, *Notre Dame*. Selected for a year-long fellowship supporting interdisciplinary engagement in research ethics.

[Mar 2026] **Outstanding Graduate Student Teacher Award (Instructor)**, *Kaneb Center for Teaching Excellence, Notre Dame*. Awarded for teaching Natural Language Processing (Fall 2025).

[May 2025] **Best Paper Award**, *W-NUT 2025*. We're Calling an Intervention: Exploring the Fundamental Hurdles in Adapting Language Models to Nonstandard Text.

[Dec 2024] **Outstanding Paper Finalist**, *TMLR*. Beyond the Imitation Game: Quantifying and Extrapolating the Capabilities of Language Models.

[Aug 2024] **Best Social Impact Paper Award**, *ACL 2024*. DialectBench: An NLP Benchmark for Dialects, Varieties, and Closely-Related Languages.

[Mar 2024] **Outstanding Graduate Student Teacher Award (TA)**, *Kaneb Center for Teaching Excellence, Notre Dame*. Awarded for Natural Language Processing (Fall 2023).

[Apr 2023] **Shared Task Winner**, *VarDial 2023*. Fine-tuning BERT with character-level noise for zero-shot transfer to dialects and closely-related languages.

[May 2021] **Computer Science and Engineering Select Fellowship**, *Notre Dame*. PhD fellowship awarded for five years.

[May 2019] **Richter Summer Research Fellowship**, *Yale University*. Awarded to conduct research during summer.

[Aug 2017] **EQT Students of Excellence Scholarship**, *EQT*. Competitive scholarship awarded for four years of undergraduate study.

PUBLICATIONS

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

[2027] Anjali Kantharuban, **Aarohi Srivastava**, Fahim Faisal, Orevaoghene Ahia, Antonios Anastasopoulos, David Chiang, Yulia Tsvetkov, and Graham Neubig. IDIOLEX: Unified and Continuous Representations for Idiolectal and Stylistic Variation. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL*.

[2026] Akriti Dhasmana, **Aarohi Srivastava**, and David Chiang. Dialect Matters: Cross-Lingual ASR Transfer for Low-Resource Indic Language Varieties. In *Proceedings of the 13th Workshop on NLP for Similar Languages, Varieties and Dialects* (VarDial).

[2025] **Best Paper Award:** **Aarohi Srivastava** and David Chiang. We're Calling an Intervention: Exploring the Fundamental Hurdles in Adapting Language Models to Nonstandard Text. In *Proceedings of the Workshop on Noisy and User-Generated Text* (W-NUT).

[2024] **Best Social Impact Paper Award:** Fahim Faisal, Orevaoghene Ahia, **Aarohi Srivastava**, Kabir Ahuja, David Chiang, Yulia Tsvetkov, and Antonios Anastasopoulos. DialectBench: An NLP Benchmark for Dialects, Varieties, and Closely-Related Languages. In *Proceedings of the Association for Computational Linguistics* (ACL).

[2023] **Aarohi Srivastava** and David Chiang. BERTwich: extending BERT's capabilities to model dialectal and noisy text. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP*.

[2023] **Shared Task Winner:** **Aarohi Srivastava** and David Chiang. Fine-tuning BERT with character-level noise for zero-shot transfer to dialects and closely-related languages. In *Proceedings of the Tenth Workshop on NLP for Similar Languages, Varieties and Dialects* (VarDial).

[2023] **Outstanding Paper Finalist:** **Aarohi Srivastava**, Abhinav Rastogi, Abhishek Rao, Abu Awal Md Shoeb, Abubakar Abid, Adam Fisch, and others. Beyond the Imitation Game: Quantifying and Extrapolating the Capabilities of Language Models. In *Transactions of Machine Learning Research* (TMLR).

[2020] **Aarohi Srivastava**, Robert Frank, Sarah Widder, and David Chartash. The Role of Linguistic Features in Domain Adaptation: TAG Parsing of Questions. In *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics* (SCiL).

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW AND NON-REFEREED PAPERS

[2026] **Aarohi Srivastava** and David Chiang. Different Perturbations, Different Mechanisms: Understanding Continued Pre-training for Zero-Shot Dialect Robustness. *Preprint*.

[2026] Akriti Dhasmana, **Aarohi Srivastava**, and David Chiang. DonorRank: Donor Language Selection for Low-Resource Cross-Lingual Speech Recognition. *Under Review*.

[2020] **Aarohi Srivastava**. Doxastic Feel Like (That). In *Yale Working Papers in Grammatical Diversity*.

Research and Professional Experience

Natural Language Processing Group, University of Notre Dame — Aug 2021 to Present

- *Graduate Research Assistant*, Advisor: Dr. David Chiang.
- **Mentoring:** Research mentor for M.S. student Akriti Dhasmana (2025–26). Mentored research on cross-lingual transfer in automatic speech recognition, resulting in a publication at VarDial 2026 and a preprint.

Tact.ai (now Aktana), Sunnyvale, CA — Jun 2021 to Aug 2021

- *Software Engineering Intern*, Supervisor: Dr. Fabrizio Morbini.

Computational Linguistics at Yale (CLAY), Yale University — May 2018 to May 2021

- *Undergraduate Research Assistant*, Advisor: Dr. Robert Frank .

Yale Grammatical Diversity Project (YGDP), Yale University — May 2020 to Jul 2020

- *Student Researcher*, Advisor: Dr. Raffaella Zanuttini.

Research Science Institute (RSI), MIT — Jun 2016 to Aug 2016

- *Research Intern*, Advisor: Dr. Justin Solomon.

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Notre Dame — Fall 2025

- Sole instructor for CSE 40657 (NLP). Designed course materials and homework assignments. Delivered lectures three times per week for the full semester. Guided student course projects and organized poster session.
- **Outstanding Graduate Student Teacher Award (Instructor)**.
- **Composite Median Score: 5.0/5.0**.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame — Fall 2023

- *Guest Lecturer*: Designed and delivered three 50-minute lectures independently for the NLP course.
- Designed a new homework assignment, conducted weekly office hours, graded assignments, and mentored students on final projects for the NLP course.
- **Outstanding Graduate Student Teacher Award (TA)**.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame — Fall 2021

- Designed a new homework assignment, conducted weekly office hours, graded assignments, and mentored students on final projects for the NLP course.

Instructor, Inspirit AI Program — Jun 2020 to Jan 2021

- Taught AI concepts to 5 cohorts of high school students.

Undergraduate Learning Assistant, Yale University — Spring 2021

- Designed a new homework assignment and conducted weekly office hours for the NLP course.

Undergraduate Learning Assistant, Yale University — Spring 2020

- Conducted weekly office hours and reviewed course materials before lectures for the NLP course.

Invited Talks and Panels

[Aug 2026] Kaneb Center TA Orientation for Engineers. **Invited panelist**. Notre Dame, IN.

[Nov 2025] Seminar on NLP for Dialects at LMU Munich. **Invited talk**. Munich, Germany (Virtual).

[Aug 2025] Kaneb Center TA Orientation for Engineers. **Invited panelist**. Notre Dame, IN.

[Aug 2024] Kaneb Center TA Orientation for Engineers. **Invited panelist**. Notre Dame, IN.

[Feb 2024] CSE Prospective PhD Student Information Session. **Invited panelist**. Notre Dame, IN.

[Nov 2023] NL+ Seminar Series. **Invited talk**. Notre Dame, IN.

[Aug 2023] CSE New PhD Student Orientation. **Invited panelist**. Notre Dame, IN.

[Apr 2023] NL+ Seminar Series. **Invited talk**. Notre Dame, IN.

Service and Leadership

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

- Program Chair and Organizer, Midwest Speech and Language Days conference. — Nov 2024 to Apr 2025
- Graduate Student Representative, CSE Committee on Inclusive Excellence and Engagement. — Sep 2024 to Jun 2025
- Department Representative, Graduate Student Government. — Aug 2023 to May 2025
- Officer, CSE Graduate Student Board. — Aug 2023 to May 2024

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Program Committee Member, DialRes Workshop. — Mar 2026 to Present
- Program Committee Member, VarDial Workshop. — Jan 2024 to Present
- Organizer, CSE Prospective PhD Student Day, Notre Dame. — Feb 2024
- Organizer, NL+ Seminar Series, Notre Dame. — Aug 2022 to Apr 2023
- Student Volunteer, NAACL. — Apr 2025
- Student Volunteer, EACL. — Apr 2023
- Reviewer for ACL Rolling Review, TMLR, ACM Computing Surveys, VarDial, and DialRes.

COMMUNITY

- NACLO Proctor (South Bend, IN). — Jan 2022, 2023, 2026
- St. Margaret's House (South Bend, IN). — Aug 2022 to Aug 2025

Additional Information

- Citizenship: United States.
- Languages: English (native), Hindi (spoken), German (intermediate).